Messaging Me

WHITE PAPER 2026

SCHOOLS & HIGHER EDUCATION

Recruiting on WhatsApp.

The guide to turning every spark of interest into a conversation, and every conversation into an application.

IN THIS GUIDE

- Understanding the API
- The strategy
- Click-to-WhatsApp
- CRM & follow-ups
- AI, then humans
- What doesn't work



Your applicants are on WhatsApp. Your school can meet them there, as long as it's useful.

Months go by between a student fair and an enrollment. During those months, your emails get lost between two newsletters and your calls go to voicemail. Your applicants, meanwhile, open WhatsApp dozens of times a day.

WhatsApp has become the place where people talk about their studies: with friends, with parents, and more and more with schools. Applicants are ready for it: 83% of people in France say they are open to messages from businesses, when those messages are relevant.

That is the condition: relevant. This guide won't teach you to send more messages. It teaches you to send the right one, at the right time: when an applicant has just downloaded a brochure, signed up for an open day, or been shortlisted. Then to keep the conversation going, with your AI, your teams and your ambassadors.

> *One useful message at the right time beats ten campaigns.*

The Messaging Me team

Conversational consulting, platform and support

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Three WhatsApps. Only one recruits at scale.

01

Same logo, same green bubble, three very different tools. Before launching an admissions campaign, you need to know **which one connects to your CRM, your ads and your teams**, and which one stops at an advisor's phone.

APP

WhatsApp

for individuals

- ✓ The everyday app, between friends and family
- ✗ No verified business name
- ✗ Nothing connects to your tools
- ✗ One phone, one person

APP

WhatsApp Business

for small teams

- ✓ Free, with quick replies and labels
- ✗ The applicant sees a number, not the school's name
- ✗ Broadcasts limited to contacts who saved your number
- ✗ No link with your CRM: no scale, no automation

The one you need

PLATFORM

WhatsApp Business API

for recruiting at scale

- ✓ Campaigns to thousands of applicants who opted in
- ✓ Connected to your CRM, your forms and your ads
- ✓ The whole admissions team on one number, with AI answering first
- ! Writing first takes a Meta-approved template, billed per message

HOW IT WORKS

You write first? It's a template message, approved by Meta before it's sent.

The applicant replies? A 24-hour window opens for free-form conversation, with your team or your AI.

Key takeaways

1. The Business app helps out a small team; it can't carry a recruitment campaign.
2. Only the API connects to your CRM and talks to thousands of applicants.
3. An approved template to open, then 24 hours of free-form conversation after each reply.

02

What it takes to write to thousands of applicants.

You don't buy the WhatsApp Business API like an app: it's opened with Meta, in your school's name. **Four pieces, and an optional fifth: the blue tick.**

1 A Meta Business portfolio

Your school's business account with Meta (business.facebook.com). Get it verified: business verification is what unlocks sending at scale.

2 A dedicated number

A free number, not already used in the WhatsApp app. Or the one of your WhatsApp Business app, which can stay there.

3 A display name

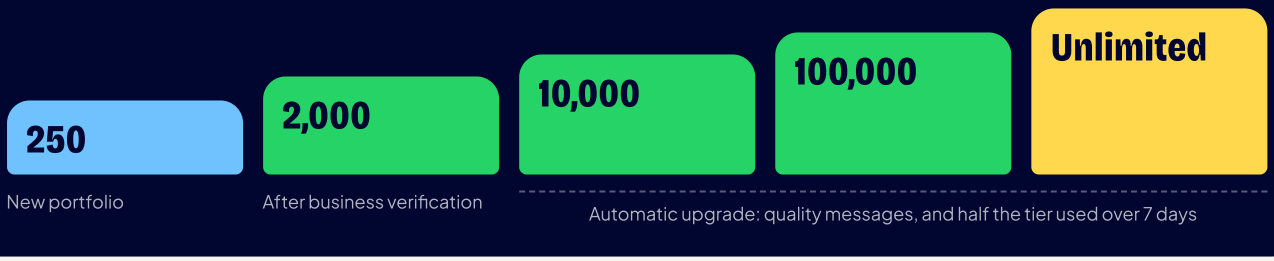
Your school's name, as the applicant reads it at the top of the conversation. Meta reviews and approves it.

4 A payment method

Meta bills each message, according to its category. Without a payment method, templates are blocked. **Your bank card, or Messaging Me can pay and advance your fees.**

Messaging limits: you start at 250 and climb fast.

Number of different contacts you can reach per 24 hours, not counting replies in an open conversation.



THE BLUE TICK



It marks an official account, next to the name. Meta grants it on request, after review: 30 days on the platform, a verified portfolio, two-factor authentication and an approved display name.

Not required to start your campaigns.

Key takeaways

1. Verify your business with Meta from day one: that's what takes you from 250 to 2,000.
2. A number dedicated to the school, never an advisor's cell phone.
3. The blue tick is a bonus, not a prerequisite.

Source: Meta, WhatsApp Business Platform documentation ("Messaging limits", "Official Business Accounts"), October 2026.

Your applicants are here.
Waiting for a useful message.

No.1

WhatsApp, the world's strongest brand in 2026.[1]

Index score 41.5, ahead of Samsung (41.4).

56M

WhatsApp users in France.[2]

891

app opens per user per month: nearly 30 a day.[5]

Demand is ahead of the brands.

83% of people in France are open to relevant messages from businesses[3]

50% of businesses believe it[3]

96%

read rate.

×4.5

more clicks for Air France on WhatsApp than by email.[4]

24 h

of free-form conversation after each applicant reply.

Sources. 1. YouGov, Best Brand Rankings 2026, BrandIndex scores from January 1 to December 31, 2025 (article of February 9, 2026). 2. Meta, 2026. 3. Kantar survey for Meta, cited in the BCG and Meta study of April 9, 2026. 4. BCG and Meta study, April 9, 2026. 5. Meta, Top Trends 2026 (891 opens per month).

Before you write, set the goal.

04

A conversation without a goal stops at the first "thanks". **Each message serves one intent, and only one**: it decides the text, the button, who takes over and what you'll measure.

THE GOAL	THE BUTTON	WHAT HAPPENS NEXT	THE METRIC
1 **Book a meeting** Admission interview, campus visit, call with an advisor.	Pick a time slot	The meeting goes into the team's calendar; the reminder arrives the day before.	Meetings booked, attendance
2 **Hand over to a person** A complex application, funding, an international applicant.	Talk to an advisor	The conversation reaches the team or an ambassador, with its full history.	Time to pick up, conversations handled
3 **Send to your website** The online application, the program page, uploading a document.	↗ Submit my application	A follow-up goes out if the application isn't completed.	Clicks, applications submitted
4 **Sign up for an event** Open day, webinar, taster day.	Sign me up	The confirmation, the reminder the day before, directions or the webinar link.	Sign-ups, attendance
5 **Qualify to guide** Level of study, target program, campus, funding.	High school Undergraduate	The applicant goes down the right path, and their CRM record fills itself in.	Records completed, split by program

THE RULE

One message, one goal, one button.

Key takeaways

1. Write down the goal before writing the message.
2. A single main button: the one for the goal.
3. Decide in advance who takes over, and how you'll know it worked.

The right moment. Or something of real value.

05

A WhatsApp message that works answers one of two questions: **what has the applicant just done? What can I give them?** If it answers neither, it doesn't go out.

Follow something the applicant did

They download a brochure

Here's the Bachelor brochure. Any question about the program or admissions?

They sign up for an open day

Your place is booked for Saturday at 10 am. Shall we send you directions the day before?

Their application is incomplete

Your transcript is missing: you can upload it here, in two minutes.

They're shortlisted

Congratulations! Here's how to prepare for your interviews, and who can answer your questions.

They're admitted

Welcome! The three steps to finalize your enrollment.

Bring something valuable

Resend the brochure
The one they downloaded, on the channel they actually open.

Invite
Open day, webinar, taster day: one invitation, a one-tap reply.

Share exclusive content
A student testimonial, a campus video, a guide like this one.

Remind them of a deadline
The application deadline, the interview time, the first day of classes.

200+ **attendees at the webinar NEOMA promoted on WhatsApp** to its shortlisted applicants: an invitation at the right moment, a one-tap reply.

Customer case presented by Messaging Me, May 2026.

Key takeaways

1. Every message follows an action by the applicant, or brings something.
2. It says why it's arriving now.
3. It ends with a question or a button: you expect a reply.

Acquire: from ad to conversation, in one tap.

06

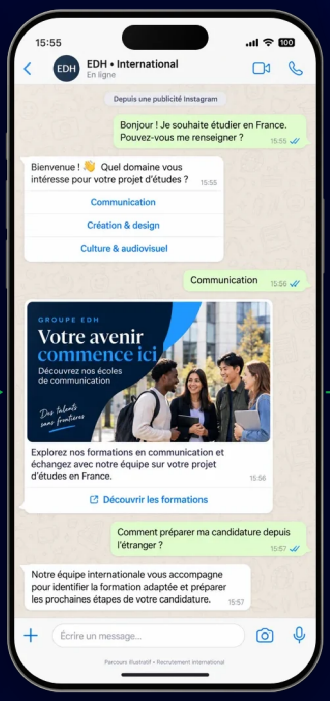
A Click-to-WhatsApp ad is a Facebook or Instagram ad whose button opens a WhatsApp conversation with your school. **No landing page, no form**: the applicant arrives with a message already written, and your flow replies within a second.

1 THE AD



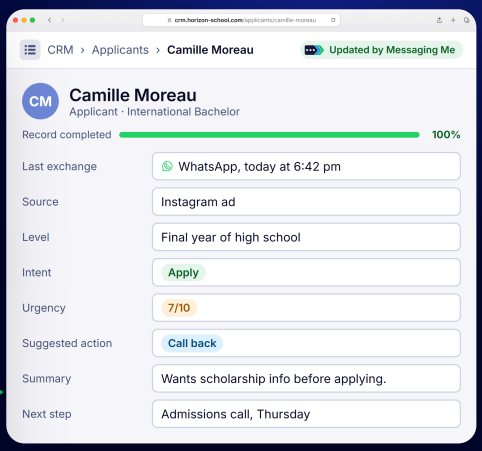
A WhatsApp button, instead of a form.

2 THE CONVERSATION



The applicant arrives with a message already written; the assistant qualifies them in a few buttons.

3 THE HANDOVER



The record lands in the CRM, analyzed, with the next action for the admissions team.

72 h

of free messages after the click: you only pay for the ad.

1 screen

The ad, the flow that replies and the results, in one place in Messaging Me.

11 countries

where Groupe EDH promotes its schools with Click-to-WhatsApp campaigns.

EDHEC International BBA ad and Groupe EDH conversation: customer cases presented by Messaging Me, May 2026, shown in French as published. The CRM record is an example.

They're already doing it.

07

Three schools, three ways to start the conversation.

NEOMA BUSINESS SCHOOL

Building preference at the decisive moments.

WhatsApp campaigns between shortlisting and the oral interviews, with requests routed to the right departments.

200+
attendees at the promoted webinar

100%
of incoming messages routed instantly

GROUPE EDH

Recruiting internationally. Centralizing follow-up.

Click-to-WhatsApp campaigns and marketing messages to promote its schools and programs in 11 countries.

30,000+
conversations started with applicants

11
accounts managed in a single platform

EDHEC BUSINESS SCHOOL

Supporting the choice of students and their parents.

Outbound marketing campaigns on WhatsApp to showcase the school and share exclusive content at the key stages of the choice.

> *Goal: building preference when it's time to choose a school.*

What they have in common: each message arrives when the applicant has a decision to make.

Source: customer cases presented by Messaging Me, May 2026.

CRM automation: the engine of what works.

08

Your CRM knows where each applicant stands. Automation means letting **every stage change trigger the right WhatsApp message**, then bringing the reply back into the record. Nobody sends anything by hand, and nobody forgets anybody.

1 **A stage changes in the CRM**
Brochure downloaded, application complete, shortlisted.

→

2 **The right template goes out on WhatsApp**
The one for that stage, with the applicant's name.

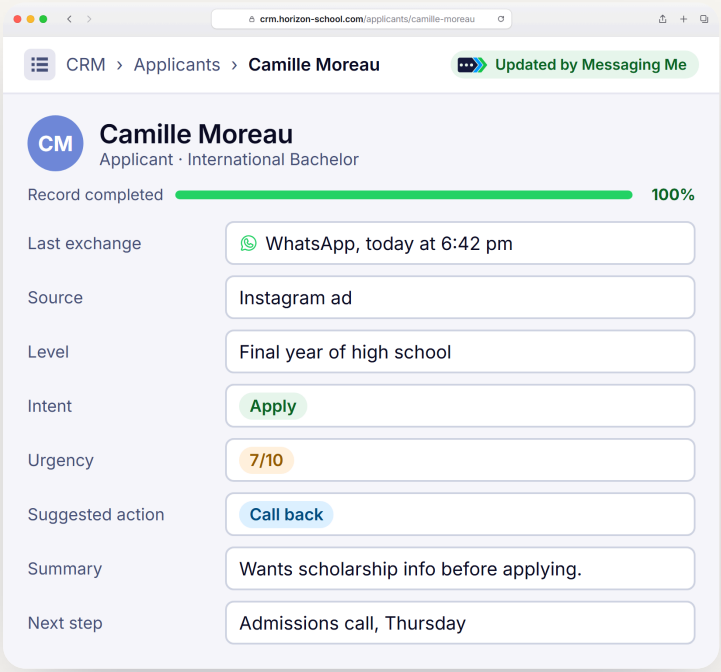
→

3 **The applicant replies**
The AI or the team picks up, in the same conversation.

→

4 **The analysis comes back into the record**
Intent, urgency, next action: you know who to call.

AND THE LOOP STARTS AGAIN AT THE NEXT STAGE



What your team sees in the CRM after each conversation. Example.

HubSpot

The analysis of each conversation lands in HubSpot, and your HubSpot lists become campaign audiences.

salesforce

The analysis of each conversation lands in Salesforce: your team knows who to call, and when.

Dynamics 365

Through the API or a webhook: your CRM notifies Messaging Me at every stage change.

OSCAR CRM

Same principle: an API call or a webhook at each stage change, or an imported export.

No CRM connected? Start anyway.

09

No.

Do you need to connect your CRM to get started?

Connecting it saves time once sending becomes daily. For your first campaigns, a list is enough.

1

Export

A list from your CRM or admissions tool, as a CSV file: name, mobile, program, relevant date.

2

Import

Into Messaging Me, with one tag per group: “shortlisted-2027”, “open-day-november”.

3

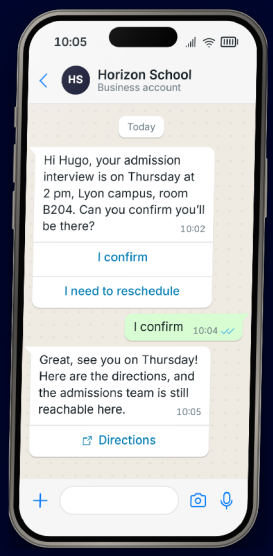
Launch

A campaign with a Meta-approved template, at the sending pace you choose.

AN EXAMPLE

Every applicant invited to an interview.

You import the list with each interview date. Messaging Me sends a reminder 48 hours before on its own, with the place and two buttons: “I confirm” and “I need to reschedule”. A date moved? The reminder follows the new date.



ONE CONDITION

Consent. Only import applicants who agreed to be contacted on WhatsApp, through a checkbox on your forms.

Key takeaways

1. A file is enough for a first campaign.
2. One tag per group, one campaign per moment.
3. Connect the CRM once imports become weekly.

10

Follow up without pestering.

A follow-up isn't the same message sent twice. **It's a new angle, at the right moment**, and it stops as soon as the applicant replies.

Day 0

The invitation

Open day on Saturday: shall we save you a place?

Day +3

No reply: a new angle

Léa, a second-year student, will be there on Saturday to answer your questions.

Yes!

They reply: the reminder the day before

See you tomorrow at 10 am! Here are the directions, and the front desk number.

Silence

Still nothing: stop

No third message. The applicant will come back on their own, or not.

1. Stop as soon as the applicant replies.
2. A new angle every time: testimonial, video, simple question.
3. One unanswered follow-up, then silence.
4. After a STOP, nothing more. Ever.
5. After 24 hours without a reply, only a Meta-approved template can go out: prepare each follow-up as a real message.

> **In Messaging Me**, a question's "no reply" delay, the "wait" block and reminders before a date do all of this with nobody involved. A STOP is honored automatically.

Key takeaways

1. A follow-up is a new angle, never the same message.
2. The applicant's reply stops everything.
3. Silence is an answer too: respect it.

AI first. Your teams next. Your ambassadors too.

11

WHAT IS A HYBRID BOT?

An AI answers right away, day and night, from your content: programs, fees, admissions, housing. It says it's an AI.

As soon as a question goes beyond what it knows, or an applicant asks to talk to someone, **it hands over to a human**, and doesn't step back in on its own.



NEOMA. The assistant invites shortlisted applicants to the interview webinar, answers, then passes a question on to the Admissions office: an advisor takes over.

Customer case presented by Messaging Me, May 2026, shown in French as published.

AI — The AI

- Answers in seconds, at any hour
- Relies only on your content
- Says it's an AI

ADM — Your teams

- Take over admissions, funding, special cases
- Find the conversation in their "to do" list
- Reply from the school's number

★ — Your ambassadors

- Students with access to the inbox
- You assign conversations to them
- They reply in their own words

Key takeaways

1. The AI answers what it knows, and only that.
2. A human takes over as soon as the question really matters.
3. Nothing convinces a future student better than a student.

12

What doesn't work: pure marketing.

WhatsApp isn't just another email. It's a conversation, or it's nothing.

✕ Avoid	✓ Do this instead
~~A promotion sent to the whole database, for no reason~~	A message that follows an action by the applicant
~~A bought list, or one imported without consent~~	Applicants who ticked the WhatsApp box
~~"One message a week, to stay top of mind"~~	A message when there's something to say
~~A message nobody can reply to~~	A question or a button, every time
~~Automating everything, with nobody behind it~~	AI first, a person when it matters
~~Following up with someone who said STOP~~	A STOP honored, for good

The test, before every send

1
Why them, and why now?

2
Can they reply in one tap?

3
Would I read it to the end, in their shoes?

! **Why it matters.** Every applicant who blocks or reports your number lowers its quality in Meta's eyes. And the quality of your messages decides your messaging limits.

Your getting-started checklist.

- [ ] **A verified Meta Business portfolio**
  The key to sending at scale
- [ ] **A number dedicated to the school**
  A free one, or your Business app's
- [ ] **An approved display name**
  The name applicants will read
- [ ] **A payment method**
  Your bank card, or Messaging Me advances your fees
- [ ] **A "WhatsApp" checkbox on your forms**
  Brochure, application, open day
- [ ] **Your first three templates**
  Invitation, reminder, incomplete application
- [ ] **Your AI's content**
  Programs, admissions, fees, housing
- [ ] **Who takes over**
  Admissions, advisors, ambassadors

Let's talk about your recruitment.

Scan, and message us on WhatsApp: it's the best demo there is.

app.messagingme.fr/en/whatsapp

Or through the form:
app.messagingme.fr/en/contact

Messaging Me
Simply conversational.

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